ROXANA GONZALEZ

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Citizenship: United States

EDUCATION

Expected May 2027	Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina
May 2022	B.A. in Economics, University of Tennessee *(Cum Laude)*

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Urban Economics, Public Economics, Artificial Intelligence, Real Estate

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Reassessed & Repossessed: Who Bears a Reassessment Shock?", Sole-Authored

Abstract: Most U.S. homes are assessed on mandated cycles of three years or longer. Appreciation goes untaxed between assessments and arrives as a discrete increase in the tax bill in the assessment year, which escrow passes through to the monthly mortgage payment. I study eight countywide assessments in the five largest North Carolina counties between 2011 and 2019, comparing each with counties that assess every year by synthetic difference in differences, and link each home's tax bill to its recorded deeds and foreclosure filings. An assessment raises a home's quarterly probability of a foreclosure filing by 31 percent, about 610 additional filings over two years in the median county. The additional filings decline steadily with home value, from 0.70 per 100 homes in the cheapest quartile to 0.37 in the most expensive. Where bills can be measured, a 10 percent larger bill increase roughly doubles the filing probability of the cheapest homes and leaves that of the most expensive unchanged. Long assessment cycles concentrate payment shocks, and the foreclosure filings that follow, on the owners least able to absorb them.

Selected Presentations: American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2026); Southern Economic Association Annual Conference (2026); National Tax Association Annual Conference (2026, accepted); College of Charleston (2026); Davidson College (2026)

RESEARCH PAPERS

"Opportunity Zones & Housing Supply" [SSRN], Sole-Authored

Selected Presentations: American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association International Conference (2026); National Tax Association Annual Conference (2026, accepted); American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2025); Southern Economic Association Annual Conference (2025)

"What Can LLMs Tell Us About the ETI?" [SSRN], with Jason DeBacker and Max Ghenis

"Opportunity for Affordability: Tax Incentives and Rental Housing Markets", Sole-Authored

Recipient of the Economics Department Best Third-Year Paper Award, 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

"The Effectiveness of Local Flavored E-Cigarette Bans", with Kara Jones and Danna Thomas

Selected Presentations: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference (2024); American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (2024)

HONORS, GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2026	NTA Equity and Inclusion Travel Fellowship ($1,500)
2026	SPARC Graduate Research Grant ($5,000), University of South Carolina Office of Research
2026	Graduate School Travel Grant ($800), University of South Carolina Graduate School
2025	Southeastern Annual Economic Conference Graduate Student Award ($1,000)
2025	Melayne Morgan McInnes Memorial Award for Best Third-Year Paper ($1,000), University of South Carolina Moore School of Business
2022	Summer Program Scholar, American Economic Association (AEA)
2018–2022	Pledge Scholar, University of Tennessee

TEACHING POSITIONS

Department of Economics, University of South Carolina Moore School of Business

Instructor of Record

Spring 2026	Introduction to Economics *Overall Instructor Rating: 4.3/5.*

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026	Professor Lois Miller
Spring 2025	Professor Sang Min Lee
Spring–Fall 2024	Professor Danna Thomas
Fall 2023	Professor Tamara Sheldon

RESEARCH POSTIONS

2025–2026	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Summer 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
Spring 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
2024	Research Assistant to Professor Danna Thomas, University of South Carolina
Fall 2023	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
2022–2023	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Spring 2022	Research Assistant to Professor Kin Blackburn, University of South Carolina
2021–2022	Research Assistant to Professor Maria Padilla-Romo, University of Tennessee

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aug. 2025–Aug. 2026	Workforce Data Scientist (part-time), South Carolina Department of Employment and Workforce

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026	Job Market Boot Camp, American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference
2025	Summer School in Urban Economics, Urban Economics Association, Tufts University
2024	Applied Data Analytics Training, Coleridge Initiative (confidential micro-data, record linkage, and machine learning)
2022	Summer Training Program, American Economic Association (AEA)

SKILLS

Statistical Software / Programming: Python, SQL, Stata, R
Quantitative Methods: Causal inference, regression, predictive modeling, machine learning
Data Skills: Collection, cleaning, validation, documentation, and dissemination of large datasets
Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

SERVICE

First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

REFERENCES

Dr. Jason DeBacker
Full Professor of Economics
University of South Carolina
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(770) 289-0340
Relationship: Committee Chair

Dr. Danna Thomas
Assistant Professor of Economics
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Relationship: Committee Member

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